

CONTENT DISCOVERY REVIEW

Cybersecurity Practical activity.

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Activity: Content Discovery review

Tools used: Gobuster

Operating system: Kali Linux

Lab environment: Authorized security testing laboratory

Objective

To perform directory and content discovery on an authorized laboratory target, manually inspect at least five discovered paths, and classify the results as useful, redirect, error, or noise.

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1). Introduction.

Content discovery is an important part of web application security testing because it helps identify directories, files, and other resources that may not be directly visible through normal website navigation. In this activity, directory discovery was performed against an authorized laboratory target using Gobuster. The discovered paths were then manually inspected to understand their responses and determine whether they were useful, redirected, produced an error, or were considered noise. This activity provided practical experience in automated content discovery and manual validation of web resources in a controlled environment.

2). Objective.

The objective of this activity was to perform directory and content discovery against an authorized lab target using Gobuster. The discovered paths were manually inspected and classified according to their observed behavior.

3). Scope and Lab environment.

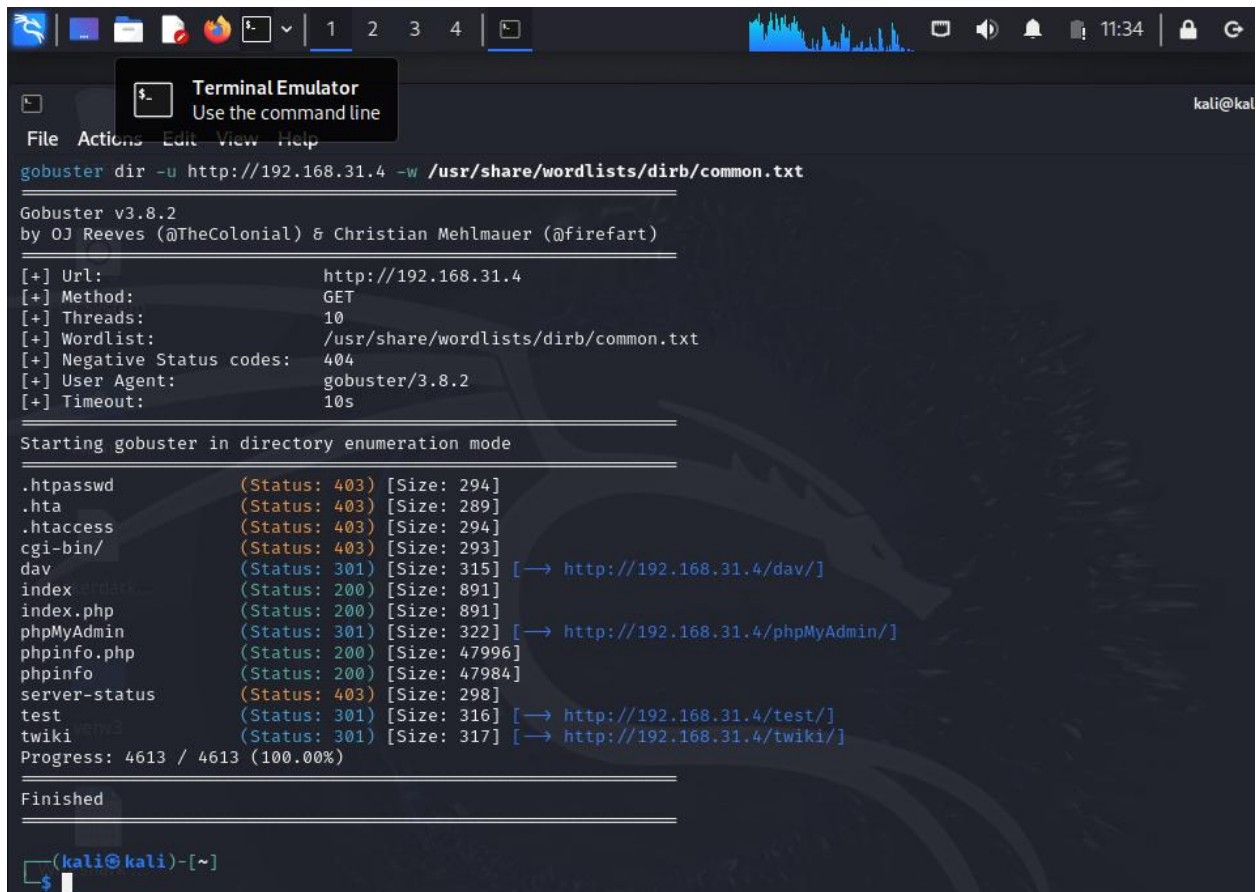
Item	Details
Target	192.168.31.4
Tool	Gobuster.
Operating system	Kali Linux.
Wordlist	Common.txt.
Testing type	Directory/content discovery.
Authorization	Controlled laboratory environment.

4). Methodology.

The following steps were performed:

1. Confirmed connectivity to the authorized lab target.
2. Used Gobuster for directory discovery.
3. Reviewed the discovered HTTP paths and status codes.
4. Selected at least five discovered paths for manual inspection.
5. Opened each path in a web browser.
6. Classified each path as useful, redirect, error, or noise.
7. Documented the findings with screenshots.

5). Directory discovery.



```
gobuster dir -u http://192.168.31.4 -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt

Gobuster v3.8.2
by OJ Reeves (@TheColonial) & Christian Mehlmauer (@firefart)

[+] Url: http://192.168.31.4
[+] Method: GET
[+] Threads: 10
[+] Wordlist: /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt
[+] Negative Status codes: 404
[+] User Agent: gobuster/3.8.2
[+] Timeout: 10s

Starting gobuster in directory enumeration mode

.htpasswd (Status: 403) [Size: 294]
.hta (Status: 403) [Size: 289]
.htaccess (Status: 403) [Size: 294]
cgi-bin/ (Status: 403) [Size: 293]
dav (Status: 301) [Size: 315] [→ http://192.168.31.4/dav/]
index.html (Status: 200) [Size: 891]
index.php (Status: 200) [Size: 891]
phpMyAdmin (Status: 301) [Size: 322] [→ http://192.168.31.4/phpMyAdmin/]
phpinfo.php (Status: 200) [Size: 47996]
phpinfo (Status: 200) [Size: 47984]
server-status (Status: 403) [Size: 298]
test (Status: 301) [Size: 316] [→ http://192.168.31.4/test/]
twiki (Status: 301) [Size: 317] [→ http://192.168.31.4/twiki/]
Progress: 4613 / 4613 (100.00%)

Finished

(kali@kali)-[~]
$
```

The target is metasploitable vulnerable machine.

`gobuster dir -u http://10.49.191.53 -w /usr/share/wordlists/dirb/common.txt`

Explanation:

`gobuster dir`

→ Directory discovery mode

`-u`

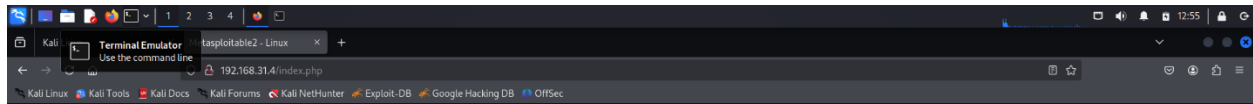
→ Target URL

`-w`

→ Wordlist

5). Manual inspection.

5.1). ./index.php



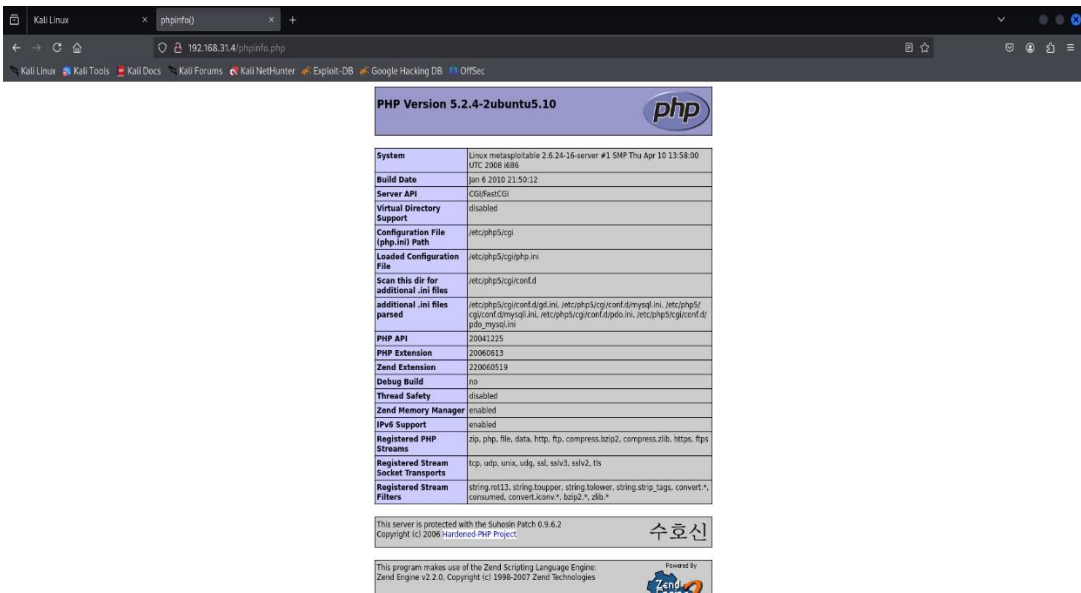
Warning: Never expose this VM to an untrusted network!
Contact: msfdev[at]metasploit.com
Login with msfadmin/msfadmin to get started

- [TWiki](#)
- [phpMyAdmin](#)
- [MutiIldae](#)
- [DVWA](#)
- [WebDAV](#)

The PHP-based web page was displayed with several links.

Classification: Useful

5.2). /phpinfo.php



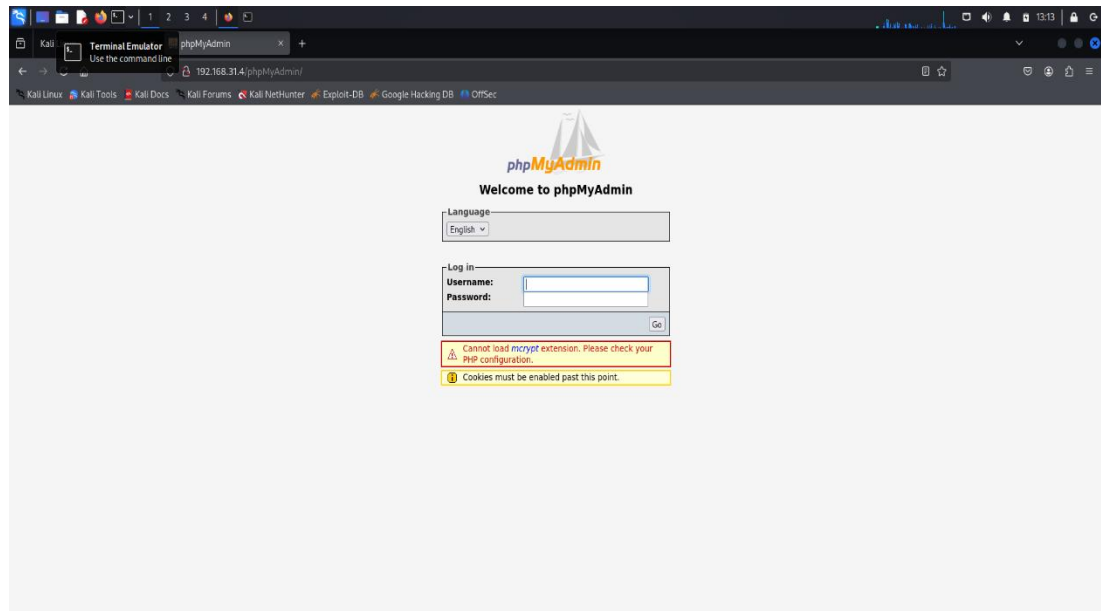
The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar displaying "192.168.31.4/phpinfo.php". The page title is "PHP Version 5.2.4-2ubuntu5.10". The content is a table of PHP configuration details.

PHP Version 5.2.4-2ubuntu5.10	
System	Linux metasploitable 2.6.26-16-server #1 SMP Thu Apr 10 13:58:00 UTC 2008 i686
Build Date	Jan 6 2010 21:59:12
Server API	CGI/FastCGI
Virtual Directory Support	disabled
Configuration File (php.ini) Path	/etc/php5/cgi
Loaded Configuration File	/etc/php5/cgi/php.ini
Scan this dir for additional .ini files	/etc/php5/cgi/conf.d
Additional .ini files parsed	/etc/php5/cgi/conf.d/gd.ini, /etc/php5/cgi/conf.d/imagick.ini, /etc/php5/cgi/conf.d/mysql.ini, /etc/php5/cgi/conf.d/openssl.ini, /etc/php5/cgi/conf.d/soap.ini, /etc/php5/cgi/conf.d/sockets.ini
PHP API	20041225
PHP Extension	20060613
Zend Extension	2206060519
Debug Build	no
Thread Safety	disabled
Zend Memory Manager	enabled
IPv6 Support	enabled
Registered PHP Streams	zip, php, file, data, http, ftp, compress.bzip2, compress.zlib, https, ftps
Registered Stream Socket Transports	tcp, udp, unix, udg, ssl, sslv3, sslv2, tls
Registered Stream Filters	string.rot13, string.toupper, string.tolower, string.strip_tags, convert.*, consumed, convert.iconv.*, bzip2.*, zlib.*
This server is protected with the Suhosin Patch 0.9.6.2 Copyright (c) 2006-2007 PHP Project	
This program makes use of the Zend Scripting Language Engine: Zend Engine v2.2.0, Copyright (c) 1998-2007 Zend Technologies	

The PHP configuration/information page was displayed with details.

Classification: Useful

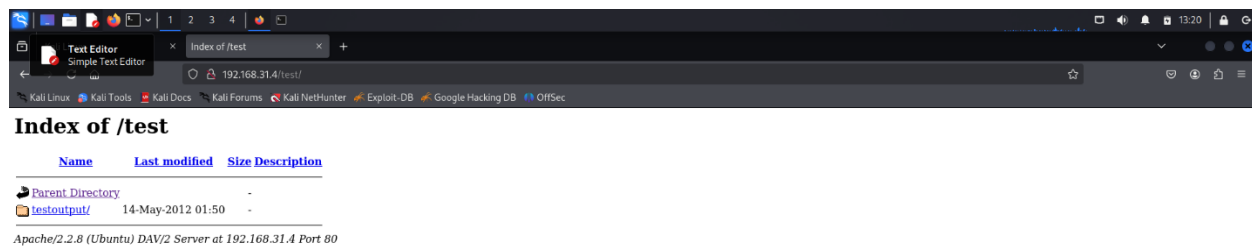
5.3). /phpMyAdmin/



The website was redirected to the login page of phpMyAdmin path.

Classification: Redirect

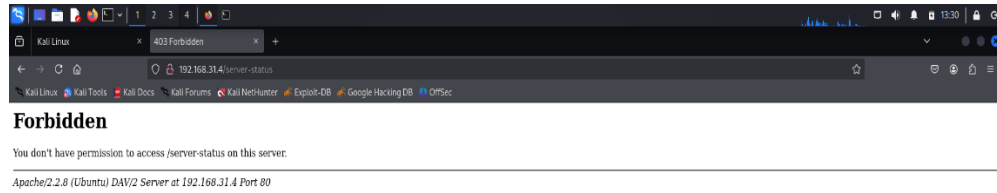
5.4). /test/



The website redirected to the test path.

Classification: Redirect.

5.5). /server-status



Access was denied for the server-status of the server.

6). Manual inspection scores.

No	Discovered path	HTTP status	Manual observation	Classification
1	/index.php	200	PHP-based web page displayed.	Useful
2	/phpinfo.php	200	PHP configuration/php page was displayed.	Useful
3	/phpMyAdmin/	301	Request redirected to the /phpMyAdmin/ login page.	Redirect
4	/test/	301	Request redirect to the /test/ path.	Redirect
5	/server-status	403	Access was denied by the server.	Error

7). Summary.

The directory discovery process identified several accessible and restricted paths on the authorized lab target. Manual inspection helped distinguish potentially useful resources from redirects, errors, and irrelevant results.

The results demonstrate that automated content discovery can identify resources that may not be immediately visible through normal website navigation.

8). Conclusion.

The activity successfully demonstrated the use of Gobuster for directory and content discovery in a controlled laboratory environment. At least five discovered paths were manually inspected and classified based on their observed responses. The exercise improved understanding of HTTP status codes, directory discovery, and the importance of manually validating automated scan results.